

CHAPTER NINE

THE GESTURES OF HANDS

Bharata speaks

1-3. So much about the minor limbs such as head, eyes, eyebrows, nose, lips and cheeks, and their description that I was to tell you. I shall now define you for the gestures of hands, breast, sides, belly, waist, thighs and feet and [explain] their proper use¹. In this connexion I shall [first of all] explain the gestures of hands and the like, that are used in the production of a play. You are to listen how they are to be applied [in acting].

Sixtyseven gestures of the hand

4-7. Gestures of single hands (*asamyuta-hasta*)¹ are twenty-four in number : Patāka, Tripatāka, Kartarimukha, Ardhaacandra, Arāla, Śukatūṇḍa, Muṣṭi, Śikhara, Kapittha, Kaṭakāmukha², Sūcyāsya (Sūcimukha), Padmakōśa, Sarpaśīraḥ, Mrgaśīrṣa, Kāṅgula, Alapadma (Alapallava), Catura, Bhramara, Hamsāsya, Hamsapakṣa, Sandamśa, Mukula, Ūṇanābha and Tāmracuḍa.

1-3 (B.1, 3, 2, G.1-3). ¹ This use relates to the two-fold Practice (realistic and coventional) on the stage (See NŚ. XIV. 62ff). The realistic Practice (*lokadharmi*) in this connexion is of two kinds, viz. (1) that reflecting one's emotion, as in arrogant reference to one's ownself, this (*patāka*) hand is to be raised on a level with the forehead (IX. 19), (2) that representing the external form of an object, as the use of the Padmakōśa hand to represent lotus and similar flowers. The conventional Practice (*natyadharmi*) is likewise of two kinds, viz. (1) that creating an ornamental effect, as the use of the four *karāṇas* of the hand (See NŚ. IX. 205-211 below), (2) that partially suggesting, a popular behaviour, as the use of the *tripatākā* hand to represent words spoken aside (*janāntika*). See Ag.

4-7 (B.G. *same*). ¹ These hands gestures are ordinarily used singly ; but at times two hands showing one of these gestures are used simultaneously. But still these are called single (*asamyuta*) hands. For, combined (*samyuta*) hands are so called because they are always to be shown by both the hands ; see Ag.

² Some mss. read this name as *khaṭakāmukha*. Our reading is

8-10. Gestures of combined hands (*saṃyuta-hasta*)¹ are thirteen in number : Añjali, Kapota, Karkaṭa, Svastika, Kāṭakāvardhamānaka², Utsaṅga, Niṣadha, Dola, Puṣpaputa, Makara, Gaḍadanta, Avahittha and Vardhamāna.

10-17. Dance-hands (*ṛtta-hasta*)¹ are Caturasra², Udvṛtta Talamukha, Svastika, Viprakirṇa, Arālakāṭakāmukha, Āviddharvaktra, Sūcyāśya, Recita, Ardharecita, Uttānavañcita, Pallava, Nīṭamba, Keśabandha, Lata, Karīhastā, Pakṣavañcitaka, Pakṣapadyotaka, Gaṇḍāpakṣa, Daṇḍāpakṣa, Ūrdhvaṃḍālī, Pārśvaṃḍālī, Uromaṇḍālī Urah-pārśvārdhvaṃḍālī, Muṣṭikasvastika, Nalinipadmakośa, Alapallava, Ulbana, Lalita and Valita.

These are the sixtyfour³ gestures of hands.

Gestures of single hands

17-26. Now listen about their definition and uses.

Patāka (flag)—the fingers extended and close against one another, and the thumb bent.

supported by the AD. (See ed. M. Ghosh, verse 124. A. K. Coomaraswamy MG. p. 50).

8-10 (B.G. *same*). ¹ See note 1 to 4-7 above.

² Some mss. read this name as *khaḷakū*^o; *kaḷakūwardhana*, is the name of a *saṃyuta-hasta* in the AD. (ed. M. Ghosh, 187 and A. K. Coomaraswamy, MG. p. 60).

10-17 (B.G. 10b-17a). ¹ These gestures (dance hands, *ṛttahasta*) as their name implies, are ordinarily to be used in dance; but in course of acting too they are often to be used along with other gestures (single and combined) to create an ornamental effect (See note 1 to I-3 above). See Ag.

² In the Skt. text these names are given in dual number e.g. our *caturasra* stands as *caturasrau*. The reason for this is to be sought in the fact that unlike the single and combined hands which must represent one single idea or object, the hands in the dance-hand gestures are to be individually moved, not for representing any idea or object but for creating an ornamental effect in acting as well as in dance. See Ag.

³ In actual enumeration hand gestures are sixtyseven in number (single 24, combined 13 and Dance-hands 30). *Catuhśaṣṭhi* in the text should be emended to *saptasāṣṭhi*. • 17-26 (B.18-25, 26a, G.18-25. 26a).

(Uses) : To represent an administration of blows, scorching heat, urging, attainment of happiness and arrogant reference of one's ownself¹ this hand is to be raised on a level with the forehead. To represent the glare of heat, torrential rain and shower of flowers two Patāka hands with the fingers separated and moving, are to be joined together. A shallow pool of water, present of flowers, grass and any design [lit. object] made on the ground are to be represented by two such hands separated from the Svastika position. The same Patāka hands with their fingers pointing downwards are to be used to represent anything closed, made open, protected, covered, dense or private (concealable). This very hand with its fingers pointing downwards and moving up and down, is to express the speedy movement of wind and [ocean] waves, [ocean waves] breaking against the shore, and flood. The Recaka of this hand should be used to represent encouragement, many [in number], a great crowd of men, height, beating of drums, and flight of birds upwards. And anything washed, pressed, cleansed, pounded, or holding up a hill or uprooting it, should be represented by the palms of two such hands rubbing each other. This is also the manner of representing man and woman².

26-32. Tripatāka (flag with three fingers)—the third finger of the Patākahand to be bent.

(Uses) : It is to be used in representing invocation, descent, bidding goodbye, prohibition, entrance, raising up [anything]¹, bowing [in salutation], comparing², suggesting alternatives, touching [the head with] auspicious objects or putting them on the head, putting on a turban or crown and covering the mouth or the ears. This very hand with its fingers pointing downwards and moving up and down is to be used in representing flight of small birds, stream, snake, bees and the like. And with the third finger of the

¹ In saying 'I too,' 'of me too,' 'by me too', in me too' and the like (Ag).

² Ag. gives detailed rules about the use of the *patāka* hand in all the cases mentioned above.

26-32 (B.G. 26b-32) ¹ Ag. thinks that this relates to objects like one's chin.

² *nidarśanam upamānopameyabhāvam* (Ag.).

Tripatāka should be represented wiping off tears, drawing a Tilaka or Patralekhā³ and touching of hairs.

33-38. Two Tripatāka¹ hands held like a Svastika represents adoration of the feet of venerable persons (*guru*). Two such hands are to meet each other's end for representing marriage. Separated and moved from this position they indicate a king. When obliquely forming a Svastika they represent planets. To indicate an ascetic they are to be raised with palm turned backwards. To represent a door they are to face each other. Submarine fire, battle and sea monsters are to be indicated by two Tripatāka hands, first raised near one's face and then moved with the fingers pointing downwards. With these very hands should be indicated jumping of monkeys, waves, wind and women. To show the crescent moon this hand should put forward its thumb, and to indicate a king's march [against his enemy] this hand should turn itself towards the back.

39-41. Kartarimukha (sissors' blades)—the forefinger of the Tripatāka hand to bend backwards.

(Uses): This [hand with its fingers] pointing downwards will represent showing the way, decorating the feet¹ or dying them², and the crawling [of babies]³. With fingers pointing upwards it will represent biting, horn and letters. And when the fingers in it are turned differently (*i.e.* the middle finger is bent backwards) it will represent falling down, death, transgression⁴, reversion, cogitation and putting [anything] in trust⁵.

³ *rocānūlabhanakam*—touching (the body) with *go-rocāna* or drawing ornamental designs (*patralekhā*) on the body with this substance. *Gorocānā* is a bright yellow pigment prepared from the urine or bile of a cow.

33-38 (B.G. 33-38). ¹ This portion does not occur in all mss., and may well have been a later addition.

² Parents, grand-parents and the spiritual guide etc. are meant by this term.

39-41 (B.G. 39-41). ¹ *racānam kasturikā dināpatrabhaṅgādikriyā* (Ag.). ² *rañjanam alaktakṛna* (Ag.).

³ Read *rūṅana* for *raṅana* in B.

⁴ *vyatikramah—aparādhaḥ* (Ag.). ⁵ *nyasta-nikṣepana*.

42. And with the two such (*saṃyuta*) hands or one such (*asaṃyuta*) hand should be represented antelope, yak, buffalo, celestial elephant (*airavata*), bull, gate (*gopura*) and hill-top.

43-45. Ardhacandra (crescent moon)—the fingers and the thumb so bent as to make a curve like a bow.

(Uses): With this should be represented young trees, crescent moon, conchshell, jar (*kalāṣa*), bracelet, forcible opening, exertion¹, thinness and drinking². With this [very] Ardhacandra hand women should represent girdle, hip, waist, face, Tālapatra³ and earring.

46-52. Arāla (bent)—the forefinger curved like a bow, the thumb also curved and the remaining fingers separated and turned upwards.

(Uses): With this should be represented courage, pride, prowess, beauty, contentment, heavenly [objects], poise, act of blessing and other favourable states. And this, again, will represent woman's gathering of hairs or scattering them and looking carefully over their entire body. The preliminaries to the marriage by bride's going round the bridegroom¹ and [marital] union² are to be represented by two Arāla hands moving around each other and their fingers meeting in the form of a Svastika. And with similar hands should be represented circumambulation, round objects, great crowd of men, objects arranged on the ground³. In calling any one, asking any one not to come in, uprooting anything,

42 (B.G. 42).

43-45 (B.G. 43-45). ¹ *āyastam khedam* (Ag.).

² *pinam* for *pinam* (B.G.).

³ *Miss. read tālapatra (tālapatra)* meaning a kind of ear-ornament (*tuḷāṅka* or *tuḷāṅka*). It is different *kuṇḍalā* from which is also an ear-ornament.

46-52 (B. 46-52, G. 46-51, 53). ¹ *kautukam—vivāhāt pūrvabhāvi vadbhūvaravor acuraḥ anlarvivāhaḥ* (Ag.).

² *vivāhaḥ—agnau sūksini pūnigrahaṇam* (Ag.).

³ Objects such as *Alpanā* and flowers arranged on the ground. For *Alpana* see *L'alpana* by Andre at Suzanne Karpelles, Paris, 1930 (?)

³ G. reads after this a couplet defining the *Arāla* hand.

saying too many things, wiping off sweat and enjoying sweet smell, abuse, censure the Tripataka hands have been prescribed before by me, but women are to use the Arāla hand to represent these.

53-54. Śukatūṇḍa (parrot's beak) - the ring-finger (third finger) of the Arāla hand is bent.

(Uses) with this should be represented words such as '(It is) not I, '(It is) not you, (It is) not to be done; invocation, farewell, and saying 'Fie (upon you)' in contempt.

55-56. Muṣṭi (fist:—fingers have their ends [bent] into the palm and the thumb [is set] upon them.

(Uses) : It is used to represent beating, exercise¹, exit, pressing², shampooing³, grasping sword and holding clubs and spears.

57-58. Śikhara (peak)—in this very hand (*muṣṭi*) the thumb raised.

(Uses) : It is used to represent reins, whip, goad, bow, throwing a javelin (*tomara*) or a spike (*śakti*), painting the two lips and feet and raising up hairs.

59-60. Kapittha (elephant-apple)—the forefinger of the Śikhara hand to be bent and pressed by the thumb.

(Uses) : It is to represent weapons such as sword, bow, discus, javelin (*tomara*), spear (*kunta*), mace, spike (*śakti*), thunderbolt and arrows, true and wholesome deeds.

61-64. Kaṭakāmukha—the ring-finger and the little finger of this Kapittha hand to be raised and bent.

(Uses) : It is used to represent sacrifice¹, oblation², umbrella, drawing up reins, fan, holding a mirror, drawing

53-64 (B.53-54, G.54-55).

55-56 (B.55-56, G.56-7). ¹ *Vyāyama* according to Ag. means *yuddha* (fight or duel).

² 'Pressing' of the teats of cows and buffaloes while milking them; *stanapīḍane—mahīsyūḍīdohane* (Ag).

³ *Samvāhana* according to Ag. means *mṛtīḍana*.

57-58 (B.57-58, G.58-59).

59-60 (B.59-60, G.60-61).

61-64 (p.41, B.60-63, G.63-65). ¹ *hotram—sruḡādi-uttānena*, Ag.

² *havyam—ājyadyāmukhena* (Ag).

[patterns]³, powdering, taking up big sticks, arranging a pearl necklace, taking up garlands, gathering the ends of clothes, churning, drawing out arrows, plucking flowers, wielding a goad, drawing out a goad, string and looking at a woman.

65-71. Sūcimukha—the fore finger of the Katakāmukha hand to be stretched.

(Uses): I shall tell you briefly of its various uses as the forefinger [in it] is raised and bent, moving sideways, shaking, moving up and down, and moving up without any rest. By moving the forefinger upwards [in this hand] are to be represented discus, lightning, banners, blossoms, earring¹, zigzag movement, a cry of approbation², young serpent, young sprout³, incense, lamp, creepers⁴, Śikhaṇḍa⁵, falling down, curve and roundness and with the forefinger raised this [hand] again should be used in [representing] stars, nose, [the number] one, club and stick. And [this hand with the forefinger] bent should meet the mouth to represent a being with teeth, and by the circular movement of this hand one should represent the taking away [a man's] every thing. And the forefinger in this hand should be alternately raised and lowered to represent long study and long day. And the same should be curved, moved up and down near the face to represent a sentence. And to indicate 'no' or 'speak' the forefinger should be stretched, shaken and moved up.

72-75. This hand should be shaken to represent anger, perspiration, hair, ear-ring, armlet and decoration of the cheeks.

³ *khaṇḍanam*—drawing decorative patterns or designs on anything. Ag's explanation of this seems to be wrong. Cf. *alakū-tilakū patrāvālini khaṇḍante* (draws the *alakū-tilakū* and *patrāvālini*) in the Kīrtitātā of Vidyāpati. See ed. Haraprasād Śāstri, Calcutta, BS. 1331 (1:24) pp. 13-14, and the root *khūl* (to draw) in E. Bengal dialect of Tippera.

65-71 (B.64-71a, G.66-72). ¹ *karnacūlikā-karnāpūra* (Ag.).

² Saying 'welldone', 'how beautiful' etc ³ *pallava* but B. *balyava*.

⁴ The text uses two words *valli* and *latū* meaning 'creeper'. Ag. distinguishes between the two as follows: *alāvū-prabhṛtayo vallyaḥ* and *drāksū-prabhṛtayo latūḥ*

⁵ *śikhaṇḍa-kumārakūṇṇ kīkapaksah* (Ag.).

72-75 (B.71b-75a, G.73-76).

And to represent pride, 'I am,' enemy, 'Who is this', and scratching of the ear it should be held near the forehead. [And two Sūcimukha hands] should be united to represent the union [of men], and be separated to indicate separation, and to represent a quarrel the two hands should be crossed, and to show bondage they are to press each other. The two Sūcimukha [hands] facing each other and held separately on the left side will represent the close of the day, and held on the right side they will indicate the close of the night.

76. This hand moved in the front will indicate [any] form, stone, whirlpool, mechanical contrivance and a hill, and to represent the serving up of meals the same movement of the hand pointing downwards is required.

77. To represent Śiva this hand pointing downwards is to be held close to the forehead and to indicate Indra this hand is to be raised [to the forehead] and held across it.

78. By two such hands the orb of the full moon is to be represented, and to indicate the rising of Indra (*i.e.* raising his banner) it should be held close to the forehead.

79. [This hand] moved all around will represent the orb of the moon, and to indicate Śiva's [third] eye, it should be held on the forehead and [in case of] Indra's [eyes it should be] raised obliquely.

80. Padmakōśa (lotus-bud)—the fingers including the thumb to be separated and their ends to bend, but not to meet one another.

81. (Uses): To represent Bilva and Kapittha (elephant-apple) fruits and the breasts of women [this hand is to be used]. But to represent accepting [these fruits] or flesh, this hand should be slightly bent at its end.

82. [This hand] should be held [to represent] offering

76 (B.77b-78a, G.77). 77 (B.78b-79a, G.78). 78 (B.75b-76a, G.79).

79 (B.76b-77a, G.80).

80 (B.79b-80a, G.81).

81 (B.80b-81a, G.82). ¹ B. adds one hemistich after this.

82 (B.82, G.83).

Pūja to a deity, carrying tribute, casket, offering the first funeral cake¹, and a number of flowers, are also to be indicated by the Padmakōśa hand.

83. The two such hands with moving fingers meeting at the wrist and turning backwards will represent the full-blown lotus and water-lilly.

84. Sarpasīrah (snake-head)—the fingers including the thumb to be close to one another and the palm to be hollowed.

85. (Uses): It is used to represent the offering of water, movement of serpents, pouring water [on anything], challenging [for a duel], motion of the elephant's frontal globes (*kumbha*) and the like.

86. Mṛgaśīrṣa (deer-head)—the Sarpasīrah² hand with all its fingers pointing downwards, but the thumb and the little finger raised up.

87. (Uses): It is moved to represent here, now, "It is", to-day, possible, splendour (*ullasana*), throw of dice, wiping off perspiration and pretended anger.

88. Kāṅgula—The middle and the fore-fingers and the thumb to be separated and the ring finger to be bent but the little finger raised.

89. (Uses): By this are to be represented immature fruits of various kinds and angry words of women.

90. Alapallava (Alapadmaka)—all fingers turned towards the palm, standing on its side and separated from one another.

91. (Uses): It is to be used for indicating prevention, words like "Who are you," "It is not", "nonsense" and a woman's allusion to herself.

¹ *agrapiṇḍa-dāna—nāndimukhaśvāddha* (Ag.).

83 (B.83, G.84).

84 (B.84, G.85).

85 (B.85, G.86).

86 (B.86, G.87).

87 (B.87, G.88).

88 (B.88, G.89). ¹ *trertāgnisamsthilāḥ=viralāḥ* (Ag.).

89 (B.89, G.90). ¹ B. reads one additional couplet (B.90) after this,

90 (B.91, G.91).

91 (B.92, G.92).

92. Catura—the four fingers stretched and the thumb bent near the middle finger.

93. (Uses) : It is to be applied in representing policy, discipline, penance, cleverness, a young girl, a sick person, spirit, deceit, proper words, welfare, truth and tranquility.

94. By one or two such hands moved round should be represented openness, deliberation, moving, conjecture and shame.

95. By the combined Catura hands are to be represented lotus-petals compared with eyes, and ears of deer.

96-98. Besides these, the Catura hand is to indicate sports, love, brilliance, memory, intelligence, judgement, forgiveness, nutrition, consciousness, hope, affection, reasoning, union, purity, cleverness, favourableness, softness, happiness, character, question, livelihood, propriety, dress, soft grass, a small quantity, wealth, defeat, sexual intercourse, merit and demerit, youth, home, wife and various colours.

99. [To represent] white it (the Catura hand) should be held up ; red and yellow are indicated by moving it round, and blue by pressing [one such hand with another].

100. Bhramara (bee)—the middle finger and the thumb crossing each other, the forefinger bent, the remaining two fingers separated and raised.

101. (Uses) : It is used to indicate the plucking of flowers with long stems such as lotus and water-lily, and ear-ring.

102. It should fall down with a sound to represent rebuke, pride of power, quickness, beating time and producing confidence.

103. Hamsāsya (swan-mouth)—the forefinger, middle finger and the thumb close¹ to one another and the remaining fingers stretched.

92 (B.93, G.93).

93 (B.94, G.94).

94 (B.95, G.95).

95 (B.96, G.96).

96-98 (B.97-99, G.97-99).

99 (B.100, G.100).

100 (B.101, G.101).

101 (B.102, G.102).

102 (B.103, G.103).

103 (B.104, G.104).

¹ *nirantarā iti viralatvam nisedhati* (Ag.).

104. (Uses) : It with the slightly throbbing end is used to indicate specially, fine, small, loose, lightness, exit, and softness.

105. Hamsapakṣa (swan-wings)—the three fingers stretched, the little finger raised and the thumb bent.

106-108. (Uses) : It is used to indicate pouring libation of water, and it should be held near the cheek to represent acceptance of a gift, Ācamana and taking meals by Brahmins, embrace, excessive stupor, horripilation, touch, unguent and gentle massage. It may again be used to indicate according to the [prevailing] Sentiment, amorous action of women relating to the region between their breasts, their sorrow and touching of their chin.

109. Sandamśa (pincers)—the forefinger and the thumb of the Arāla hand crossed and the palm a little hollowed.

110. The Sandamśa (hand) according to the Sentiments and States, is of three kinds, viz. that [held] in front, that near the mouth and that on one side.

111-115. (Uses) : In representing the plucking of flowers, making garlands of them, taking up grass, leaves, hairs or thread and holding or pulling out an arrow or thorn the Sandamśa should be held in one's front. And to represent taking off a flower from its stem, the wick [of a lamp], [collyrium] stick, filling up [any vessel with any thing], in saying 'fie [upon you]', and anger, this should be held near the mouth. To represent the sacred thread, piercing a hole [in pearls and similar objects], bow-string, fineness, arrow, and objects aimed at, yoga, meditation and small quantity [two] such hands should be combined. This shown by the left hand held on one side and slightly turning its tip is used to represent softness, abuse and envy. It is used also to indicate painting, colouring one's eyes, deliberation, stem, drawing Patralekhā and squeezing of lac-dye by women.

116. Mukula (bud)—the fingers bent and close to one another and their tips meeting together in the Hamsāsya hand.

104 (B.105, G.105).

105 (B.106, G.106).

106-108 (B.107-109, G.111).

109 (B.110, G.110).

110 (B.111, G.111).

111-115 (B.112-116, G.).

116 (B.117, G.117).

117-118. (Uses) : It is used to represent the making of offerings in worshipping a deity, bud of a lotus or a water-lily, throwing a kiss (*viṭa-cumbana*), contempt, miscellaneous things, taking meals, counting of gold coins, narrowing of the mouth, giving away [anything], quickness and buds of flowers,

119-120. *Ūṇanābha* (spider)—the fingers of the Padmkośa hand [further] bent.

(Uses) : It is used to represent the combing of hair, receiving stolen goods, scratching one's head, skin disease, lions, tigers and such other animals, and taking up [touch]—stone.

121-122. *Tāmracuḍa* (lit. copper-crest i.e. cock)—the middle finger and the thumb crossed, the fore-finger bent, the remaining [two fingers] at the palm.

(Uses) : It should fall down with a sound to represent rebuke, beating time, inspiring confidence, quickness, and making signs.

123. This hand is to be used to indicate small fractions of time such as Kalā, Kāṣṭhā, Nimeṣa and Kṣaṇa as well as talking to a young girl and inviting her.

124. When the fingers in a hand are close to one another, bent and the thumb is set on them, the same is [also] called the *Tāmracuḍa* hand.

125. By this hand are to be indicated hundred, thousand and lac of gold coins, and when the fingers in it are suddenly made to move freely it will represent sparks or drops.

126. O the best of Brahmins, these are the single hands described by me. Now hear about the combined hands which I am going to describe.

117-118 (B.118-112, G.118-119). ¹ *viṭacumbanam svābhiprāyam āvīskartum svahastam eva mukulitam viṭaś cumbantīti viṭacumbanam* (Ag.).

119-120 (B.120-121, G.120-121). ¹ Cf. Ag's explanation of *caurya-graha*.

121-123 (B.122-124, G.122-123).

123 (B.124, G.124).

124 (B.125, G.125).

125 (B.126, G.126).

126 (B.127, G.127).

127. Añjali—Putting together of the two Patāka hands is called Añjali.

(Uses) : It is used to greet gods, venerable persons (*guru*) and friend¹.

128. In greeting gods it is to be held on the head, in case of venerable persons it is to be held near one's face, and for greeting the friends it is to be placed on the breast, and in case of the remaining persons there is no fixed rule.

129. Kapota (pigeon)—The two (Añjali) hands meeting on one of their sides will make the Kapota hand. Listen about its uses.

130. (Uses) : It is to be used to indicate an approach with inimical attitude, bowing and talking to a venerable person. To indicate cold and fear, women are to hold this hand on their breasts.

131. The hands [showing the Kapota gesture] released after the meeting of fingers will indicate anxious words, or 'This much can be done' or 'Nothing more can be done.'

132. Karkaṭa (crab)—When the fingers of the hands are interlocked the Karkaṭa hand is produced.

133. (Uses) : It is used to indicate the bees-wax, massaging of the limbs, yawning just after awakening from sleep, a big body, supporting the chin and holding a conch-shell [for blowing it].

134. Svastika—The two Arāla hands upturned and held together at the wrists will form the Svastika. It is to be used by women.

135. (Uses) : When the hands are separated from the Svastika position, it will indicate directions, clouds, the sky, forests, seas, seasons, the earth and similar [other] extensive things.

127 (B.128, G.128).

128 (B.129b-30a, G.129). ¹ B. adds one additional hemistich after this.
129 (B.130b-131a, G.130).

130 (B.131b-132a, G.131).

131 (B.132b-132a, G.132).

132 (B.133b-134a, G.133).

133 (B.134b-135a, G.134).

134 (B.135b-136a, G.135).

135 (B.136b-137a, G.136).

136. Kaṭakāvardhamānaka—When one Kaṭakā (mukha) hand is placed on [the wrist of] another Kaṭakā [mukha] hand the Kaṭakāvardhamānaka hand will be produced.

(Uses) : It is to be used in movements connected with love-making and in bowing [to a person].

137. Utsaṅga—When the Arāla hands are contrarily placed and are held upturned and bent, the Utsaṅga hand will be the result.

(Uses) : It is used to indicate the feeling of touch.

138. It is also used to indicate anything to be done with great effort, acts of anger and indignation, squeezing [anything] and women's acts of jealousy.

139-140. Niṣadha—The left hand holding the [right] arm above the elbow and the right hand similarly touching the left arm with a clenched fist will make a Niṣadha hand.¹

141. (Uses) : It is to indicate patience, intoxication, pride, elegance, eagerness, valour, arrogance self-conceit, haughtiness motionlessness, steadiness and the like.

142. Dola—When the two shoulders are at ease in a Karaṇa and the two Patāka hands are hanging down the Dola hand is produced.

143. (Uses) : It is to be used in indicating hurry, sadness, fainting, fit of intoxication, excitement, state of illness and wound by a weapon.

144. Puṣpapuṭa—The two Sarpaśiraḥ hands with their fingers close to one another meeting on one side very closely will give rise to the Puṣpapuṭa hand.

136 (B.137b-138a, G.137). 137 (B.139, G.138). 138 (B.140, G.139).

139-140 (B.144-145). ¹ G. omits this passage and 141, and read them differently, but in the footnote to lines 11-16 the definition occurs, and the uses too. B. also gives an additional definition and uses of the Niṣadha in B.141 143.

141 (B.146). ¹ See note 1 to 139-140.

142 (B.148, G.142). 143 (B.149, G.143).

144 (B.150, G.144). 145 (B.151, G.145).

145. (Uses) : It is to be used to indicate the receiving or carrying of rice, fruits, flowers and foods of various kinds and the carrying and removing of water.

146. Makara—When the two Patāka hands with their thumbs raised are turned down and placed on each other the Makara hand is produced.

147. (Uses) : It is used to indicate lion, tiger, elephant, crocodile, shark (*makara*) and fish and other carnivorous animals.

148. Gajadanta—The two Sarpaśiraḥ hands, touching the opposite arms between the shoulder and the elbow will give rise to the Gajadanta hand.

149. (Uses) : It is to be used to indicate the carrying of the bridegroom and the bride, excessive weight, clasping a pillar and uprooting a hill or a block of stone.

150. Avahittha—When the two Śukatundī hands meet each other on the breast and are bent and then slowly lowered, the Avahittha hands will be the result.

151. (Uses) ; It is to be used in indicating weakness, sigh, showing one's body, thinness [of the body] and longing [for a beloved person].

152. Vardhamāna—When the Mukula hand is clasped by the Kapittha the result will be the Vardhamāna hand.

153. (Uses) : By pressing one hand with the other it is used to indicate grasping, receiving, preserving, convention (or doctrine) truthfulness and abridgement.

154. Or the two Hamsapakṣa hands turned down will be the known as the Vardhamāna. (Uses) : It is to be used to represent the opening of objects like latticed windows.

155. The two kinds of hands (single and combined)

146 (B.152, G.146).

147 (B.153, G.147).

148 (B.154, G.148).

149 (B.155, G.149).

150 (B.156, G.150).

151 (B.157, G.151).

152-153. ¹ Ms. G. of G. and *ḍa* of B. read the passages as we do but B. and G. reject this and read them differently.

154 (B.158, G.152).

155 (B.160, G.153).

described briefly may be used elsewhere also in conformity with the rules laid down here.

General rules regarding the use of hand gestures

156. In acting, hand [gestures] should be selected for their form, movement, significance, and class according to the personal judgement [of the actor].

157. There is no gesture (lit. hand) that cannot be used in indicating [some] idea. I have profusely described whatever forms (lit. gestures) are usually seen [to be associated with different ideas].

158. There are besides other popular gestures (lit. hand) connected with other ideas, and they also are to be freely used along with the movements inspired by the Sentiments and the States.

159. These gestures should be used by males as well as females with proper regard to place, occasion, the play undertaken and a suitability of their meaning.

Different movements of hand gestures

160. I shall now describe the varied movements which these gestures (lit. hands) [should] have in connexion with the [different] Sentiments and States.

161-163. [These movements are]: drawing upwards, dragging, drawing out, accepting, killing, beckoning, urging, bringing together, separating, protecting, releasing, throwing, shaking, giving away, threatening, cutting, piercing, squeezing and beating.

164. Hand gestures according to the theory of Histrionic Representation are to have three kinds of general movements, viz. upwards, sideways and downwards.

165. These movements of hands should at the time of their use, be embellished by means of [suitable] expressions in the eyes, the eyebrows and the face.

156 (B.161, G.154).

158 (B.163, G.156).

160 (B.165, G.158).

164 (B.169, G.173).

157 (B.162, B.G.155).

159 (B.164, G.157).

161-163 (B.166-168, G.159 161).

165 (B.170, G.162).

Spheres of hand gestures

166. The experts are to use the hand gestures according to the popular practice and, [in this matter] they should have an eye to their movement, object, sphere, quantity, appropriateness and mode.

167. Hand gestures of persons of the superior type should move near their forehead, that of the middling type of persons at about their breasts while the inferior persons [should move their hand gestures in regions] below this.

The quantity of gestures

168. In the superior acting, hand gestures should have scanty movement, in the middling acting medium sort of movement, while the ordinary acting should have profuse movements of hand gestures.

169. To indicate different objects and ideas the hand gestures of persons of the superior and the middling types [in such cases] should conform the definitions given [in the Śāstra] while gestures of the persons of inferior type should follow the popular practice and their [own] natural habit.

170. But when [specially] different occasions or times present themselves, wise people should make different uses of the hand gestures.

171-174. While a person is to represent himself as sad, fainting, terrified, overcome with disgust or sorrow, weak, asleep, handless, inactive, drowsy, inert, sick, attacked with fever, seized with panic, attacked with cold, intoxicated, bewildered, mad, thoughtful, practising austerities, residing in a cold region, prisoner under arrest, running very swiftly, speaking in dream, suddenly moving away and cutting nails he is not to use hand gestures, but he should resort to the Representation of the Temperament as well as to the change of voice suitable to the different States and Sentiments.

166 (B.171, G.163).

168 (B.173, G.165).

170 (B.175, G.167).

167 (B.172, G.164).

169 (B.174, G.166).

171-174 (B.176-179, G.168-171).

175. At the time of verbal acting (*i.e.* when the actor will enunciate his part) the eyes and the look are to be directed to points at which the hand gestures are moving, and there should be proper stops so that the meaning may be [clearly] expressed (*lit. seen*)¹.

176. The movements of hands in dancing and acting will be of five kinds, viz. palms kept upwards, downwards or oblique, fingers pointing upwards or downwards.

177. These are the hand gestures connected with the various kinds of *Histrionic Representations*. I shall now speak of *Dance-hands* (*i.e.* gestures to be used in dance).

The Dance-hands

178. *Caturasra*—two *Kaṭakāmukha* hands held forward eight *Āṅguls* apart [from each other] on one's breast, the two shoulders and elbows on the same level.

179. *Udvṛtta*—the two *Haṃsapakṣa* hands waved like a palm-leaf (fan). Its alternative name is the *Tālavṛnta* (palm-leaf).

180. *Talamukha*—the two hands from the *Caturasra* position to be held obliquely facing each other.

181. *Svastika*—the *Talamukha* hands crossed at the wrists ; but released after this they are called *Viprakirṇa*.

182. *Arālakataṭakamukha*—the two *Alapallava* (*Alapad-maka*) hands with palms upwards changed into *Padmakośa* hands. Its another name is *Arālakataṭaka*.

183. *Āyiddhavaktraka*—The two hands are to have a graceful (*krūṭila*) movement after touching [successively] the opposite shoulder, elbow and hands, and the palms [of the hands] moved are to turn towards the back.

175 (B.180, G.172). ¹ B. repeats here 164 (B.169)

176 (B.182, G.175). 177 (B.183, G.176).

178 (B.184, G.177). 179 (B.185, G.178).

180 (B.186, G.179). 181 (B.187, G.180).

182 (B.188, G.181). ¹ B.G. read after this a variant of this definition. 183 (B.190, G.183).

184. *Sūcimukha*—The two *Sarpaśiraḥ* hands with their thumbs touching middle fingers are to stretch their tips obliquely.

185. *Recita*—the two *Hamsapakṣa* hands swiftly moving with the palms facing upward This is like the ordinary *Recita* [of the hands].

186. *Ardharecita*—The left hand should be as in the *Caturasra* and the right hand as in the *Recita*.

187. *Uttānavañcita*—The two *Tripatāka* hands are slightly bent obliquely and the shoulders and the elbows are moved.

188. *Pallava*—the two *Patāka* hand joined at the wrist.

Nitamba—the two *Patāka* hands taken out from the shoulder [to the hip].

189. *Keśabandha*—the two hands moved out from the hair-knot (*keśabandha*) and held on the sides.

190. *Latā*—the two hands to be obliquely stretched sideways.

191. *Karihasta*—the *Latā* hand held up and swung from side to side and the *Tripatāka* hand held on the ear.

192. *Pakṣavañcitaka*—one *Tripatāka* hand placed on the waist and another on the head.

193. *Pakṣapadyotaka*—the *Pakṣavañcitaka* hands changing places (*i.e.* the hands placed on the waist to be put on the head and *vice versa*).

194. *Daṇḍapakṣa*—the two *Hamsapakṣa* hands moved alternately and then held out like a staff.

195. *Ūrdhvamaṇḍali*—the two hands to have circling movement near the upper region (*i.e.* the upper part of the body).

184 (B.191, G.184). ¹ B.G. read after this a variant of this definition.

185 (B.193, G.186).

186 (B.194, G.187).

187 (B.195, G.188).

188 (B.196, G.189).

189 (B.197, G.190).

190 (B.198, G.191).

191 (B.199, G.192).

192 (B.200, G.193).

193 (B.201, G.194).

194 (B.202, G.195).

195 (B.203, G.196).

Pārsvamaṇḍali—the same movement made on one side.

196. *Uromaṇḍali*—after circling movements one hand to be raised up and the other to hang down, and movements to take place near the breast.

197. *Urahpārsvārdhamāṇḍala*—the *Alapallava* (*Alapadmaka*) and *Arāla* hands moved by turns above the breast and on the sides.

198. *Muṣṭikasvastika*—the two *Kaṭakāmukha* hands bent at the wrists and moved round.

199. *Nalinipadmakośa* the hands to be moved by turns with *Vyavartita* and *Parivartita* *Karāṇa*.

200. *Allapallava*—the two hand to have the *Udveṣṭita* *Karāṇa* in their movements.

Ulbana—the two hands to be stretched up and waved.

201. *Lalita*—two [*Ala*]-*pallava* (*Alapadmaka*) hands to be moved above the head.

Valita—the two *Latā* hands crossed at their elbows.

202. The Dance-hands are to be used in forming *Karāṇas* and hands such as the *Patāka* should be used in representing the meaning [of words].

203. [But] sometimes, out of necessity their uses are interchanged, and the names given are due to their predominant use in drama and dance.

204. The Dance-hands are of two kinds : single and combined. I shall now speak of hands in relation to the *Karāṇas*.¹

The four *Karāṇas* of the hand

205-206. Instructors of hand gestures are to note carefully the four classes into which all such gestures are grouped. The four classes are : *Āveṣṭita*, *Udveṣṭita*, *Vyavarita* and *Parivartita*.

196 (B.204, G.197). 197 (B.205, G.198). 198 (B.206, G.199).

199 (B.207, G.200). 200 (B.208, G.201). 201 (B.209, G.202).

202 (B.210). ¹ G. omits this. 203 (B.211). ¹ G. omits this.

204 (B.212, G.203). ¹ This *Karāṇa* is evidently differently from the K. mentioned in NŚ. IV. 62ff. 205-206 (B.213-214, G.204-205).

207. *Āveṣṭita* : When the fingers beginning with the first one (the forefinger) are gradually pointing inwards at the time [the hand] moves round, the *Karaṇa* [thus produced] is called *Āveṣṭita*.

208. *Udveṣṭita* : When the fingers beginning with the first one [forefingers] are gradually pointing outwards at the time [the hand] moves round, the *Karaṇa* thus produced is called *Udveṣṭita*.

209. *Vyavartita* : When fingers beginning with the last one (the little finger) are gradually pointing inwards at the time [the hand] moves round the *Karaṇa* thus produced is called *Vyavartita*.

210. *Parivartita* : When the fingers beginning with the last one (the little finger) are gradually pointing outwards at the time [the hand] moves round, the *Karaṇa* thus produced, is called *Parivartita*.

211. Hand gestures in their [various] movements when applied in drama and dance should be followed by *Karaṇas* having [appropriate expression of] the face, the eyebrows and the eyes.

The movements of arms

212-213. Persons dealing in drama and dance have prescribed ten [movements] of arms : *Tiryak*, *Ūrdhvagata*, *Adhomukha*, *Āviddha*, *Apaviddha*, *Maṇḍala*, *Svastika*, *Añcita*, *Kuñcita* and *Prsthaga*.

214. O Brahmins, I have now finished the brief description of rules regarding the *Karaṇas* and shall speak afterwards about the movements of the breast, the belly and the sides.

Here ends Chapter IX of Bharata's *Nāṭyaśāstra*
which treats of the Gestures of Hands.

207 (B.215, G.206).

209 (B.217, G.208).

211 (B.219, G.210).

213 (B.221, G.212).

208 (B.216, G.207).

210 (B.218, G.209).

212 (B.220, G.211).

214 (B.222, G.213).